

KIQ 1.1 — Final Takeaway

What functionalities and services do METRO's e-commerce platform and mobile app offer to support ordering and customer interaction?

Methodological positioning

This project's required analytical toolkit is **patent analysis (Espacenet)** and **scientific-literature analysis (SCOPUS)** via text mining (occurrence, co-occurrence, n-grams). The KIT 1 strategy is therefore **course-method-first**: SCOPUS and patent corpora are used as the primary evidence base wherever a KIQ permits, and direct web scraping is deliberately reserved for the single question where literature and patents structurally cannot answer — **direct customer perception (KIQ 1.4)**. For KIQ 1.1 the SCOPUS corpus is used to build a **capability framework** for digital ordering platforms; METRO's own publicly documented features are then mapped onto that framework to answer the question directly.

Step 1 — Capability framework from the literature

Occurrence and co-occurrence analysis of two SCOPUS corpora (a 29-article discovery/interaction set and a 300-article ordering/fulfillment set) surfaces two consistent capability layers that define what a digital ordering platform does:

- **Discovery & interaction layer** — product search, filtering and navigation, usability/UX, recommendation and personalization, semantic retrieval.
- **Ordering & fulfillment layer** — order management, logistics and delivery, marketplace coordination, supply-chain integration, service efficiency.

Co-occurrence shows the two layers are tightly linked: interaction quality (search, UI, UX) and fulfillment (logistics, marketplace, satisfaction) are interdependent, with the marketplace acting as the connective structure.

Step 2 — Mapping METRO onto the framework

Reading METRO's publicly documented digital portfolio (M|Shop, METRO MARKETS, M|Companion) against the framework gives the direct answer to the KIQ:

Framework capability	METRO's offering (publicly documented)	
Product search & filtering	M Shop catalog search & filters; M Companion product search + availability/stock check	✓
Order placement & reorder	M Shop web ordering; saved lists / reorder; METRO MARKETS multi-vendor cart	✓
Delivery / click-and-collect	FSD delivery; store pickup / click-and-collect; depot collection	✓
Customer account & order history	M Companion account management, digital card, invoice/receipt history; multi-user company accounts	✓
Recommendation / personalization	Present but less mature than digital-natives (see KIQ 3.2)	■
Marketplace coordination	METRO MARKETS hybrid marketplace (own catalog + 3rd-party vendors)	✓

Direct answer to KIQ 1.1

METRO's customer-facing digital portfolio covers **both** capability layers the literature identifies. On the discovery/interaction layer it offers product search, filtering, availability checking and account

management (strongest in M|Companion); on the ordering/fulfillment layer it offers web ordering, reorder, delivery and click-and-collect, and a hybrid marketplace (M|Shop + METRO MARKETS). The one relatively underdeveloped capability versus the framework is recommendation / personalization — a gap that KIQ 3.2 confirms quantitatively. METRO's functional coverage is broad; its differentiation gap is in intelligence/personalization, not in core ordering functionality.